

CALIFORNIA SDI • PATIENT RESOURCE

How to actually get help with your California SDI claim

If you're on State Disability Insurance (SDI) and can't get a human on the phone, you're not alone — and the phone is not your only option. Here are the routes that work, starting with the one most people don't know about.

01 The route most people miss

When the EDD phone line won't get you a person, go around it.

FASTEST WAY TO BREAK A STUCK CLAIM

Ask your California state legislator's office for help

Every California resident has a **State Assembly Member** and a **State Senator**. Their offices have staff whose job is to help constituents cut through state agencies — including EDD. This is often the single most effective way to get a stuck SDI claim moving. It's free, and it's a normal part of what their office does every day.

- 1 Find your representatives at **findyourrep.legislature.ca.gov** — enter your home address.
- 2 Open your Assembly Member's website and look for “**Contact,**” “**Help with a State Agency,**” or “**EDD Assistance.**”
- 3 Submit a short message: your name, the agency (**EDD - State Disability Insurance**), your claim number if you have one, and what's stuck.
- 4 Ask them to open a **constituent case** and act as your liaison with EDD. Keep the confirmation and follow up in about a week.

In our district (Northridge / West San Fernando Valley): that's Assembly District 40, Assemblymember **Pilar Schiavo**. Her office has an “*EDD Assistance Needed*” option on its contact form. If you live elsewhere, use the finder above to reach *your* representative.

02 EDD phone numbers

Save these. The automated system runs 24/7 for claim status; live reps keep business hours.

Disability Insurance (SDI)

English & general SDI claims

1-800-480-3287

Paid Family Leave (PFL)

Bonding / caregiving claims

1-877-238-4373

SDI — Spanish

Servicio en español

1-866-658-8846

TTY / hearing or speech impaired

California Relay Service — then give the EDD number

Dial 711

Live representatives: Mon–Fri, 8:00 a.m.–5:00 p.m. PT (closed state holidays)

Automated info line: 24 hours / 7 days

03 Ask in writing through myEDD

No hold music. You get a written answer tied to your claim.

Signing in to **myEDD / SDI Online** at myedd.edd.ca.gov is usually faster than calling — and it's the fastest way to apply, upload documents, and check status. To send EDD a question about an existing claim:

- Sign in to myEDD and open **SDI Online**.
- Select the **Claim ID** for your current claim.
- Choose **“Request Claim Update”** and pick a request type.
- Type your question and submit — EDD responds directly on your claim.

04 If you do have to call

Small things that cut the hold time.

- **Call right at 8:00 a.m.** when lines open, and try Tuesday–Thursday rather than Monday.
- After the recordings, **say “representative” or press 0** to reach a person.
- Have ready: your **Social Security number** or EDD Customer Account Number, your **Claim ID**, and a pen.
- Write down the **date, time, and name** of anyone you speak with.
- Still stuck after a couple of tries? **Go back to Step 01** — your legislator's office.

05 In person

EDD has SDI field offices around the state. Find the nearest one with the **Office Locator** at edd.ca.gov/en/office_locator.

Official sources: EDD “Contact State Disability Insurance” (edd.ca.gov/en/disability/Contact_SDI) · myEDD (myedd.edd.ca.gov) · California Legislature “Find Your Representative” (findyourrep.legislature.ca.gov). Phone numbers and hours verified July 2026 — EDD can change them, so confirm on edd.ca.gov.

This handout is general information to help you reach the right office. It is not legal advice and is not affiliated with or endorsed by the EDD or any government agency. Your doctor's office does not manage or decide SDI claims — those decisions are made by EDD.